

THE Chicken Report

A report submitted in conformity with the requirements
for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy

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*Please promptly stop reading and destroy this document at once if you are my Lipidologist
(or any medical doctor as a matter of fact).*

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Overview

This report compares popular fast food and chain restaurant chicken dishes, mainly focusing on fried and grilled varieties. Criteria include taste, texture, seasoning, juiciness, price, and overall value. The order of the review is sorted alphabetically. All reviews were based on personal experience and preference, the finding and conclusion of this work is therefore indisputable.

Chains Compared

- bb.q. Chicken
- Chick-fil-A
- Church's Chicken
- Jollibee
- KFC
- Mary Brown's
- Nando's
- Popeyes

- The Fry

Evaluation Criteria

Each chicken offering is evaluated on a 3 point scale based a combination on the following:

1. **Flavor and Juiciness**
2. **Crunch/Char Quality (fried vs grilled)**
3. **Side Offerings**
4. **Gravy/Sauce**
5. **Price**
6. **Accessibility**

2.1 bb.q Chicken

This is a korean fried chicken chain that opened its first location in Canada back in 2018. The growth of locations within Canada has been very rapid with over 50 locations nationwide, up to 8 locations in downtown Toronto core alone. This is a nice alternative to the other Korean fried chicken chain The Fry, with a decent selection of side offering and more locations.

- **Flavor:** The seasoning is standard, meat is reasonably juicy 2/3
- **Crunch:** Generally quite crispy without being dry 2.5/3
- **Sides:** Decent selection of sides from kimchi fries to cheese balls 2/3
- **Gravy:** N/A
- **Price:** High entry price, but some combos offer better values 2/3
- **Accessibility:** 15 locations in GTA, opens till late 2.5/3
- **Notes:** Excellent alternative to The Fry, author's current favourite.

2.2 Chick-fil-A

A chicken focused fast-food chain, originated from the deep south - Georgia, very Christian.

- **Flavor:** Decent seasoning and overall quite moist, quality of meat is good 2/3
- **Crunch:** Generally crispy 2/3
- **Sides:** Waffle fries are decent but otherwise ordinary 1.5/3
- **Sauce:** A good selection of sauces 2/3
- **Price:** \$7.39 (sandwich only) 1.5/3

- **Accessibility:** 11 locations in GTA, hours vary depending on locations, but none open on Sundays 1.5/3
- **Notes:** Decent option for a chicken sandwich.

2.3 Church's Chicken

A chicken chain from the deep south, Georgia. It's offering is similar to popeyes and KFC but kinda average in every aspect, jack of all trade, master in none.

- **Flavor:** The seasoning is okay 1.5/3
- **Crunch:** Okay crunch 1.5/3
- **Sides:** Limited, mostly just fries 1.5/3
- **Gravy:** Average 1.5/3
- **Price:** \$10.99 (2-piece combo with side + drink) 2/3
- **Accessibility:** 33 locations around town 1.5/3
- **Notes:** Chicken is not bad but popeyes can do everything better.

2.4 Jolibee

Originated from the Phillippines.

- **Flavor:** The seasoning is great, spice coating has a good kick to it 3/3
- **Crunch:** Very crispy outside, perfect crunch 3/3
- **Sides:** Great selection of sides from fries to pasta, though the style might not be everyone's 2/3
- **Gravy:** Fantastic, should be sold by the gallon 3/3
- **Price:** \$10.99 (2-piece combo with side + drink) 2/3
- **Accessibility:** 11 locations around town and closes quite early 1/3
- **Notes:** Great chicken overall, but held back from high prices and short hours.

2.5 KFC

The famous Colonel Sanders Kentucky Fried Chicken that needs no introduction.

- **Flavor:** Overall pretty bland, more oily than juicy if anything 1/3
- **Crunch:** Tend to sit too long at the counter so not crunchy 1/3
- **Sides:** Standard selection of sides, some seasonal items are interesting but rarely deserving repeated visit 1.5/3

- **Gravy:** Still one of the best part of KFC 2.5/3
- **Price:** \$10.99 (2-piece combo with side + drink) 2/3
- **Accessibility:** Countless amount of locations but they do shut early ish 1.5/3
- **Notes:** Pretty much bottom of the barrel compared to the rest of the chicken chains.

2.6 Mary Brown's

A Canadian fast food chain specializing southern fried chicken.

- **Flavor:** The seasoning is good, reasonably juicy inside 2.5/3
- **Crunch:** Crisp outside but something feels missing 2/3
- **Sides:** Signature taters are just potato wedges, does not hold up well during delivery 1.5/3
- **Gravy:** Good 2/3
- **Price:** \$10.99 (2-piece combo with side + drink) 2/3
- **Accessibility:** 20 locations in GTA, closes at midnight 2/3
- **Notes:** Overall good if seeking alternative to popeyes, best for dine-in, otherwise throw into oven for abit once food arrives to crispy up the skin again.

2.7 Nando's

A South-African chain serving Portugese style grilled chicken, widely popular in UK (aka cheeky nando's).

- **Flavor:** The seasoning is good and meat is rarely dry 2.5/3
- **Crunch/Char:** Excellent char on grilled chicken 3/3
- **Sides:** Wide selection, from fries to brussel sprouts 3/3
- **Sauce:** Pretty good selection 2.5/3
- **Price:** \$10.99 (2-piece combo with side + drink) 2/3
- **Accessibility:** Several location around town 2/3
- **Notes:** This is a great alternative to fried chicken to keep your lipidologist from screaming at your during your next visit (they will only yell instead).

2.8 Popeyes

Originated from Louisiana, focused on bold Cajun seasoning.

- **Flavor:** Strong Cajun seasoning with a noticeable spicy kick, tends to be juicy 2/3

- **Crunch:** Normally quite crispy 3/3
- **Sides:** Cajun fries are go-to, easily best fries among all fast food chains 3/3
- **Gravy:** Very watery and bland 1/3
- **Price:** \$10.99 (2-piece combo with side + drink) 3/3
- **Accessibility:** 100 locations around GTA and quite a few remains open even well past midnight 3/3
- **Notes:** Overall great but must inspect order if takeout, they have a tendency to miss items depending on the location.

2.9 The Fry

A korean fried chicken chain, style is similar to kentucky fried chicken but normally comes with either sliced green onion or coated in sauce. They also tend to utilize the entire chicken (not just the thigh and wings).

- **Flavor:** The seasoning is more neutral, but not bland 2/3
- **Crunch:** Generally quite crispy without being dry 2.5/3
- **Sides:** Selection of sides from garlic and cheese powder fries to corn in butter 2/3
- **Gravy:** N/A
- **Price:** High entry for their signature fried chicken 1.5/3
- **Accessibility:** 7 locations in GTA, but opens late 2/3
- **Notes:** Overall solid.

Comparison Table

Table 1: Chicken Comparison Summary

Chain	Flavor	Crunch	Sides	Gravy/Sauce	Price	Accessibility	Overall
bb.q Chicken	2.0	2.5	2.0	N/A	2.0	2.5	2.2
Chick-fil-A	2.0	2.0	1.5	2.0	1.5	1.5	1.8
Church's	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	2.0	1.5	1.6
Jollibee	3.0	3.0	2.0	3.0	2.0	1.0	2.3
KFC	1.0	1.0	1.5	2.5	2.0	1.5	1.6
Mary Brown's	2.5	2.0	1.5	2.0	2.0	2.0	2.0
Nando's	2.5	3.0	3.0	2.5	2.0	2.0	2.5
Popeyes	2.0	3.0	3.0	1.0	3.0	3.0	2.5
The Fry	2.0	2.5	2.0	N/A	1.5	2.0	2.0

Reheating Methods

Based on the delivery distance or leftover, a guideline for reheating the leftover fried chicken is proposed. Preheat oven to 350F, once up to temp, put chicken in for 10-20min, for best results, inset thermo probe and aim for 120F. If leftover fries are also present, throw the fries in after 10min to avoid overcooking.

Conclusion

Among all tested options, Popeyes stands out for consistency and affordability, Jollibee stands out for bold flavor and good side selection, bbq Chicken offers great Korean style fried chicken. KFC and Church's provide more traditional takes that vary in consistency. Alternatively, Cheeky Nando's offers a "healthier" grilled alternative that potentially reduces the frequency of PCSK9 inhibitors injection required.

Future Work

In terms of immediate future work, it is suggested to expand the scope of the study to include different continents (at least 5). To ensure a low p-value, repeated assessment of each item is required. One dimensional POD analysis can be performed to identify hidden correlations. To facilitate the long term feasibility of the proposed work, it is strongly recommended that a parallel project on the invention of a teleportation device be initiated ASAP. Such device will be installed within the stomach, allowing for immediate removal of all fat, sodium and cholesterol from the ingested chicken.